



Richard Lawrence

There are two kinds of data engineers meeting AI right now.

The Worried and The Curious.

Both are smart. One is about to have a much better couple of years.

Which one are you?



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● The Worried

The Worried see AI as a threat to the skills they spent years building.

That's understandable.

But it turns into resistance, and every conversation ends up being about what could go wrong.



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- The Curious

The Curious ask a different question.

“How could this help me do more?”

Could it take the repetitive work off my plate, and give me time for the problems I actually enjoy?



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● The Worried

They tried an AI tool once.

The output was almost right,
but not quite.

So they decided it can't be
trusted, and went back to
doing everything by hand.



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- The Curious

They don't trust it blindly either. Only **33%** of developers say they trust AI accuracy.*

So they check the output, keep their own judgement, and use it where it genuinely helps.



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● **The Worried**

Their week is failed jobs,
reruns and patching the
pipeline that breaks every
time a schema changes.

It's the job they know, so they
protect it.



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- The Curious

They hand the upkeep to automation.

Then they spend the time closer to the business: understanding what people are trying to achieve and asking better questions.



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- **The Worried**

Their value stays tied to the tasks they do.

And tasks are exactly what automation is getting good at.



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- The Curious

Their value grows with the problems they solve.

Their experience and domain knowledge end up counting for more, not less.



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At BigHammer.ai, the second mindset is the one we most want to work with.

Automating the mundane work is where it starts.

Human judgement stays at the centre.

Which one sounds more like **your** team?